Block 5

Survey and Quantitative Observation Techniques

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Survey Method

- A **Survey Method** is a structured questionnaire administered to a sample of a target population, designed to elicit specific information from participants.

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Survey Methods

- Participants may be asked a variety of questions regarding their behaviour, intentions, attitudes, awareness, motivations and demographic and lifestyle characteristics.

- These questions may be asked verbally, in writing or via a computer (including mobile devices), and the responses may be obtained in any of these forms

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Structured Data Collection

- In structured data collection, a formal questionnaire is prepared and the questions are asked in a prearranged order

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Fixed-Response Alternative Questions

- require the participant to select from a predetermined set of responses.

	Strongly agree	*Agree*	*Neutral*	*Disagree*	*Strongly disagree*
I prefer written examinations compared with continual assessment	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

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Fixed-Response Alternative Questions

Advantages

- simple to administer
- consistent because the responses are limited to the alternatives
- coding, analysis and interpretation of the data are relatively simple

Disadvantages

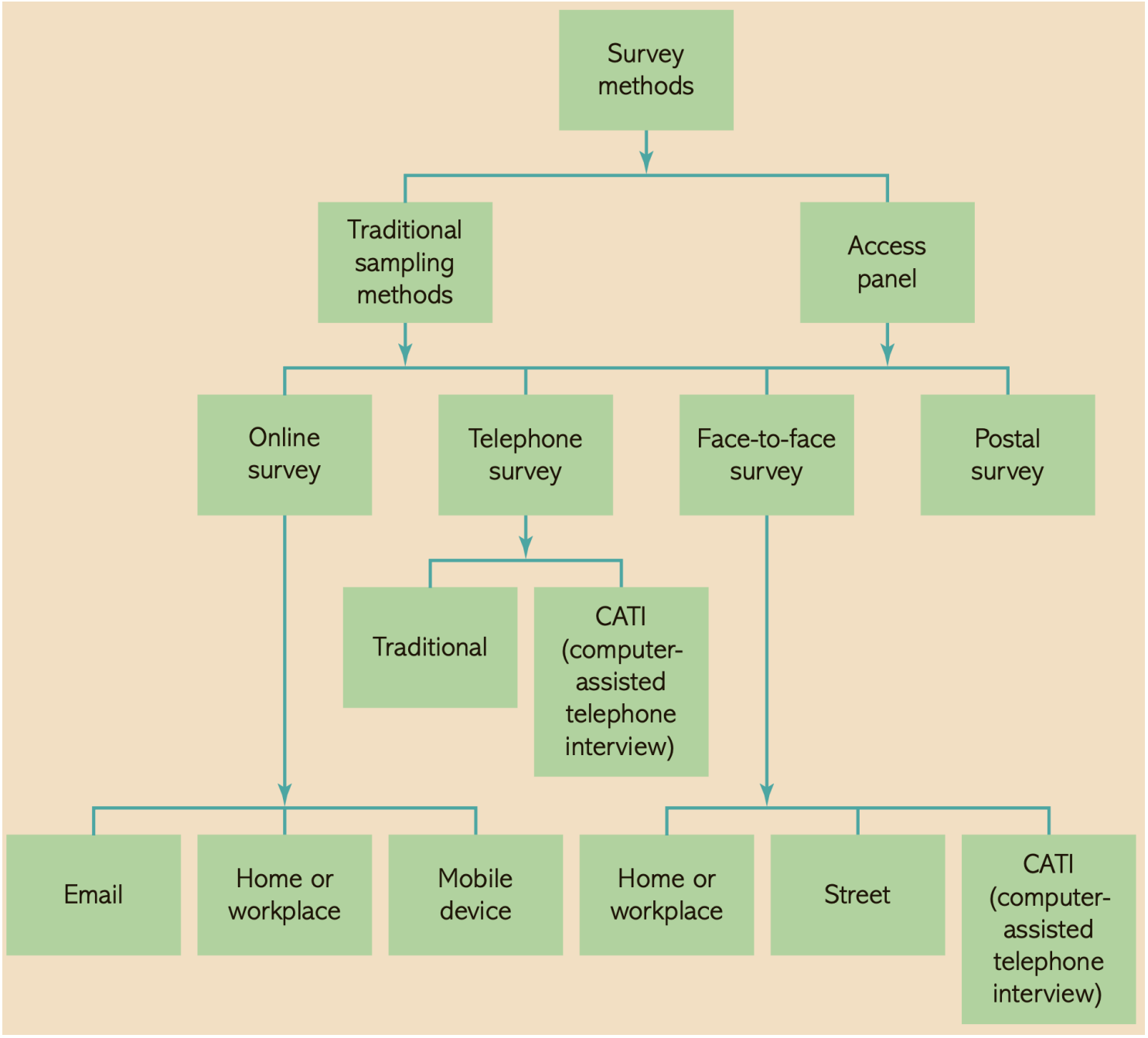
- participants may be unable or unwilling to provide the desired information
- may result in loss of validity for certain types of data, such as beliefs and feelings
- wording questions in a consistent manner to all potential survey participants is not easy

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Access to Survey Participants

- Can get participants in two different ways

- 4 ways to administer surveys



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Online Surveys

- Using Email- OLD
- Using Fixed and Mobile devices- C

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Online Surveys

Advantages

- Speed
- Cost
- Quality of response
- Interviewer Bias Removed
- Data Quality
- Contacting Certain Groups

Disadvantages

- Sampling Frames
- Access to the Web
- Technical Problems

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"Surveytainment"

- Interactive Surveys meant to be more entertaining for the participants

- Like a game

https://exavo.de/surveytainment

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Telephone Surveys

Traditional Telephone Surveys

- Interviewer calls participants and records their answer on a paper questionnaire

OUTDATED

Computer-assisted telephone interviews (CATIs)

- Interviewer records answer directly into a computer
- CATI system dials participants, gives questions 1 at a time and validates the answer recorded
- CATI system changes questions depending on prior answers

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Face-to-Face Surveys

Home or Workplace Surveys

- participants are interviewed face to face in their "personal space"
- High cost but high quality

Street Surveys

- participants are intercepted while they are shopping in city centres or shopping centres
- They may be questioned there and then in the street, or taken to a specific test facility

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Omnibus Surveys

- The omnibus survey is a cost-effective means of measuring and tracking consumer awareness, behaviour and attitudes

- omnibus survey incorporates a range of topics. The costs for each survey are directly shared between clients in proportion to the number of questions each decides to include.

- Cost Sharing mechanism for organizations

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Computer-Assisted Personal Interviews (CAPIs)

- Partially replaces the interviewer
- user-friendly software packages that design easy-to-use surveys with help screens and understandable instructions
- Used to collect data at test facilities from street surveys, product clinics, conferences and trade shows

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Postal Surveys

Outgoing envelope	Method of addressing; envelope size; colour; postage
Covering letter	Personalisation; sponsorship; type of appeal; signature
Questionnaire	Size, length and content; colour and layout; format and reproduction; participant anonymity
Instructions	As part of covering letter; a separate sheet; alongside individual questions
Return envelope	Whether to include one; type of envelope; postage
Incentives	Feedback of findings; monetary v. non-monetary; prepaid v. promised amount

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Evaluating Survey Techniques

	Email	Online	Telephone CATI	Home and workplace	Street surveys	CAPI	Postal
Flexibility of data collection	*	****	****	*****	*****	****	*
Diversity of questions	***	****	*	*****	*****	*****	***
Use of physical stimuli	*	***	*	****	*****	*****	***
Sample control	*	**	****	****	****	***	*
Quantity of data	***	****	**	***	***	***	**
Response rate	*	**	***	*****	****	*****	*
Control of data-collection environment	*	*	***	****	*****	*****	*
Control of field force	*****	*****	***	*	***	***	*****
Potential for interviewer bias	None	None	***	*****	*****	*	None
Potential to probe participants	*	*	*	*****	***	***	*
Potential to build rapport	*	*	***	*****	****	****	*
Speed	*****	*****	*****	****	***	****	*
Low cost	*****	*****	***	*	**	**	****
Perceived participant anonymity	***	*****	***	*	*	*	*****
Social desirability	*****	*****	***	**	*	****	*****
Obtaining sensitive information	***	***	*	*****	*	***	***
Low incidence rate	***	*****	*****	*	*	*	***
Participant control	*****	****	**	*	*	*	*****

(key: low = *, moderate to low = **, moderate = ***, moderate to high = ****, high = *****)

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Response Rate Reductions

- concerns about confidentiality
- the length of interviews
- the relevance of questions
- the number of requests
- when there is no direct benefit to the company

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Sugging and Frugging

- SUGGING - Selling Under the Guise of Research

- FRUGGING-Fundraising Under the Guise of Research

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Evaluating Survey Techniques

- Control of field force – the ability to control the interviewers and supervisors involved in data collection.
- Control of the data collection environment – the degree of control a researcher has over the environment in which the participant answers the questionnaire.
- Cost – the total cost of administering the survey and collecting the data.
- Diversity of questions – the diversity of questions which can be asked in a survey depends on the degree of interaction the participant has with the interviewer and the questionnaire, as well as the ability to actually see the questions.
- Flexibility of data collection – the flexibility of data collection is determined primarily by the extent to which the participant can interact with the interviewer and the survey questionnaire.

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Evaluating Survey Techniques

- Quantity of data – the ability to collect large amounts of data.
- Response rate – the survey response rate is broadly defined as the percentage of the total attempted interviews which are completed.
- Sample control – sample control is the ability of the survey mode to reach the units specified in the sample effectively and efficiently.
- Social desirability – social desirability is the tendency of participants to give answers which they feel to be acceptable in front of others, including interviewers.
- Speed – the total time taken for administering the survey to the entire sample.
- Use of physical stimuli – the ability to use physical stimuli such as the product, a product prototype, commercials or promotional displays during the interview.

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Evaluating Survey Techniques

- Obtaining sensitive information – sensitive information may mean an issue which is personally sensitive, such as the way in which a participant may be classified or the use of hygiene products. What may be deemed ‘sensitive’ varies enormously between different types of participant.

- Perceived participant anonymity – perceived participant anonymity refers to the participants’ perceptions that their identities will not be discerned by the interviewer or the researcher.

- Potential for interviewer bias – the extent of the interviewer’s role determines the potential for bias.

- Potential to build rapport – rapport may be vital to communicate why the survey is being conducted, with a corresponding rationale for the participant to spend time answering the questions.

- Potential to probe – though the interviewer has the potential to create bias in the responses elicited from participants, it is balanced somewhat by the amount of probing which can be done

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- **Quantitative observation** involves recording the behavioural patterns of people, objects and events in a systematic manner to obtain information about the phenomenon of interest.

- The observer does not question or communicate with the people being observed unless he or she takes the role of a **mystery shopper**. Information may be recorded as the events occur or from records of past events.

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Types of Observation

Unstructered Observation

- the observer monitors all aspects of the phenomenon which seem relevant to the problem at hand – for example, observing children playing with new toys.

Structured Observation

- the researcher specifies in detail what is to be observed and how the measurements are to be recorded – for example, an auditor performing inventory analysis in a store.

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Disguised Observation

- the participants are unaware that they are being observed
- disguise may be accomplished by using two-way mirrors, hidden cameras or inconspicuous electronic devices
- observers may be disguised as mystery shoppers or sales staff
- When a participants knows they are being observed, that is called undisguised observation

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Disguised Myster Shopper

- A major UK-based charity that Age UK fights for the rights of older people
- They believed that motor and travel insurance companies were discriminating older individuals

- They recruited two groups, test group of individuals 65-85 and control group of 30 to 49.
- Found that insurance companies age discriminated on price and service

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Disguised Mystery Shopper

Personal Visits

- How long were you in the queue?
- How many tills were open?
- Did the counter clerk apologise if you were kept waiting?
- What form of greeting or farewell was given?

Telephone Calls

- How many rings were there before the phone was answered?
- Did the person who answered the phone go on to answer all your questions?
- Were you asked a password?
- How many times during the conversation was your name used?

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Types of Observation

Natural Observation

- involves observing behaviour as it takes places in the environment
- For example, one could observe the behaviour of participants eating a new menu option at Mcdonalds

Contrived Observation

- Observing participants' behaviour is observed in an artificial environment, such as a test kitchen.

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Personal Observation

- a researcher observes actual behaviour as it occurs
- the observer does not attempt to manipulate the phenomenon being observed but merely records what takes place
- a researcher, for example, might record the time, day and number of shoppers who enter a shop and observe where those shoppers ‘flow’ once they are in the shop.

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Electronic Observation

- electronic devices rather than human observers record the phenomenon being observed.
- They are used for continuously recording ongoing behaviour for later analysis.

- Neuromarketing is concerned with the direct measurement of the brain's conscious and unconscious response to marketing stimuli.

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Devices Not Requiring Participants' Direct Participation

- the AC Nielsen audimeter
- turnstiles which record the number of people entering or leaving a building
- on-site cameras (still, motion picture or video)
- optical scanners in supermarkets.(checkout)

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Devices Requiring Participant Involvement

- eye-tracking equipment
- pupilometer
- psychogalvanometer
- voice-pitch analysis
- devices measuring response latency.

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Nueromarketing Tools

- Quantitative electroencephalography (qEEG)
- Pupilometer- measures pupil size
- Psycho-Galvanometer- mesaures the changes in the electrical sking resistance of the skin
- Voice-Pitch Analysis -Measurement of emotional reactions through changes in a participant's voice.
- Response Latency-The amount of time it takes to respond to a question

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Audit

- The researcher collects data by examining physical records or performing inventory analysis. Data are collected personally by the researcher. The data are based on counts, usually of physical objects

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Trace Analysis

In trace analysis, data collection is based on physical traces, or evidence of past behaviour:

- the selective erosion of tiles in a museum could be used to determine the relative popularity of exhibits
- the number of different fingerprints on a page could be used to gauge the readership of various advertisements in a magazine
- the radio station playing in cars brought in for service could be used to estimate the audience share of various radio stations
- the age and condition of cars in a parking lot could be used to assess the affluence of customers
- the magazines people donated to charity could be used to determine people's favourite magazines
- internet visitors leave traces which could be analysed to examine browsing and usage behaviour by using a cookie.

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Comparison of Observation Techniques

Criteria	Personal observation	Electronic observation	Trace analysis
Degree of structure	*	* to *****	***
Degree of disguise	***	****	*****
Natural setting	*****	****	*
Observation bias	*****	*	***
Analysis bias	*****	**	***
General remarks	Most flexible	Can be intrusive	Limited traces available

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Questions